

SEVENTEEN's V8 Sub-Unit Drops Debut EP with Pharrell Williams

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The 8 and Vernon are diving into the theme of "**wasted youth**" on the **mini-album** due out on June 29. SEVENTEEN members The 8 and VERNON are gearing up to launch the first **mini-album** from their new **side unit**, V8. The self-titled **mini-album**, due out on June 29, finds the K-pop duo teaming up with a long list of big-name producers, including former collaborator Pharrell Williams. According to a release announcing the project, it is a deep dive into the theme of "**wasted youth**," with the songs focused on "raw moments of wandering and confusion experienced through time, along with the resilience and growth found within those struggles. Rather than defining the youth spent as mere lost time, the album **sublimates** the unstable and fragile nature of youth into an explosive sense of freedom, channeling that energy into a driving force to continuously forge ahead." In addition to Pharrell - who produced the song "Bad Influence" from the group's fifth studio album, 2025's Happy Burstday - the **mini-album** will feature the pair working with longtime collaborator BUMZU, as well as a number of other producers, whose names were revealed in a clever video clip featuring the list burning in reverse to reveal the roster. Among the names on the paper are German **electro house** producer/DJ Mechatok, 100 Gecs' Dylan Brady, Korean Music Awards winner KIRARA, as well as a number of other pop, electronic and hip-hop producers, including: Alice Longyu Gao, BADTREE, HAKASEEE, Han Jung In, Jake Torrey, kimj, Lodge Boy, Lucian, MILLENNIUM, Numbernine, Ramzoid, Rhode, Robb Roy, Rudolph, Sophie Cates, Stella Smyth, UHD, and Will Not Fear. The duo teased their upcoming debut with a grainy 30-second video that included them lounging in an apartment, throwing food at each other and dancing through a shower of fireworks in front of a billboard featuring their group name, soundtracked by a snippet of their **hyperpop** sound. It's a bold, exciting new direction for the two artists.

Word Treasure

side unit -- A smaller group formed from members of a larger band to explore a different musical style.

mini-album -- A music release that is longer than a single but shorter than a full album, often called an EP.

hyperpop -- A music genre that blends pop with exaggerated electronic sounds, distortion, and high-pitched vocals for a chaotic, futuristic feel.

sublimates -- Transforms something raw or negative into a higher, more positive form, like turning fragile emotions into explosive art.

wasted youth -- A phrase describing time lost or spent without clear purpose during young years, often linked to confusion or aimlessness.

electro house -- A subgenre of electronic dance music that combines house beats with heavy basslines and synthesized melodies.

Background you need

SEVENTEEN is a 13-member K-pop boy band that debuted in 2015 and is known for writing and producing its own music, often splitting into sub-units for different genres.

Pharrell Williams is a Grammy-winning American musician, singer, and producer famous for hits like 'Happy' and for his work with The Neptunes, and he previously collaborated with SEVENTEEN on their 2025 album 'Happy Burstday.'

Hyperpop is a genre that emerged in the 2010s, defined by pitched-up vocals, digital distortion, and frantic beats; artists like 100 geecs helped popularize it.

BUMZU is a South Korean producer and songwriter who has worked with SEVENTEEN since their early days, often acting as a key musical partner in the group's creative direction.

Break it down

LEAD: SEVENTEEN members The 8 and Vernon form sub-unit V8 for a debut mini-album.

+ - THEME: 'wasted youth' explored through music.

KEY RELEASE: Self-titled mini-album due out on June 29.

COLLABORATORS:

+ - Pharrell Williams (produced 'Bad Influence' on 2025 album 'Happy Burstday').

+ - Longtime producer BUMZU.

+ - International producers' names revealed via a burning video.

PRODUCERS LIST: Mechatok, Dylan Brady (100 Geecs), KIRARA, and many others.

+ - Genres span electro house, pop, electronic, hip-hop, hyperpop.

ALBUM CONCEPT: Sublimates fragile youth into explosive sense of freedom.

TEASER: Grainy 30-second video shows lounging, food fight, dancing through fireworks.

SOUND: Snippet of hyperpop signals a bold new artistic direction.

Why it matters

V8's exploration of wasted youth speaks directly to teenagers' feelings of uncertainty, and the global collaboration shows how music can cross borders to create something fresh and relatable.

Test what you remember

1. Which two SEVENTEEN members form the V8 sub-unit?

- ☐ (A) SCoups and Woozi
- ☐ (B) The 8 and Vernon
- ☐ (C) Vernon and Dino
- ☐ (D) DK and Jeonghan

2. What is the central theme of the mini-album?

- ☐ (A) First love
- ☐ (B) Wasted youth
- ☐ (C) Celebration
- ☐ (D) Heartbreak

3. Which famous producer who previously worked on 'Bad Influence' is collaborating on this mini-album?

- ☐ (A) Pharrell Williams
- ☐ (B) Mechatok
- ☐ (C) Dylan Brady
- ☐ (D) BUMZU

4. How was the list of producers revealed?

- ☐ (A) In a press conference
- ☐ (B) Via a video of the list burning in reverse
- ☐ (C) Through a social media post
- ☐ (D) At a live concert

5. Which member of 100 Gecs is listed as a producer on the album?

- ☐ (A) Mechatok
- ☐ (B) Dylan Brady
- ☐ (C) KIRARA
- ☐ (D) Alice Longyu Gao

6. What kind of sound was featured in the teaser video?

- ☐ (A) R&B
- ☐ (B) Hyperpop
- ☐ (C) Acoustic
- ☐ (D) Classical

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: A 4: B 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Positive:** Fans are excited that The 8 and Vernon can showcase new artistic sides, and the involvement of Pharrell Williams and hyperpop producers boosts global attention for K-pop.
2. **Critical:** Some worry that sub-units can be a marketing tactic to keep the group's brand alive, and the hyperpop sound might alienate fans who prefer traditional K-pop.
3. **Neutral:** Hyperpop remains a niche but influential genre; blending it with K-pop illustrates how Internet-era music quickly merges styles from different cultures.
4. **Forward-looking:** If V8 succeeds, it could pave the way for more experimental K-pop sub-units and encourage collaboration between Western avant-garde producers and Korean artists.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):